W45 Weekly script

DECODE UPSC with Mounika

November 1st Week Current Affairs 2026

Reading script · English + తెలుగు · Sunday 8 November, 6 PM

Script

What if I told you that this one week changed the Agnipath scheme, your Deepavali crackers, and the two-child rule in panchayat elections?

ఇవన్నీ ఈ ఒక్క వారంలో జరిగాయి.

I am Mounika, and in the next 10 minutes, we will decode the 11 most important stories of November's first week, with the exact trap for each one. Ready?

మన ప్రయాణం start చేద్దాం.

Here is our map for today: four big national decisions, two defence stories, two world stories, two important days, and one alert for Telugu aspirants at the end.

1 · Agnipath

Let us start with the story every defence aspirant is searching for: the Agnipath scheme has changed.

When Agnipath began in 2022, Agniveers served four years, and only about one in four stayed on. Now the Union Cabinet has approved a change: about three in four Agniveers will get two more years of service, with a pathway to regular enrolment, subject to selection.

Prelims trap: the scheme has not been scrapped; it has been modified, and entry is still through the four-year Agniveer route.

ఇది గుర్తుపెట్టుకోండి.

2 · Green crackers

And with Deepavali here, our second story is about crackers.

On November 2, the Supreme Court allowed only certified green crackers in Delhi and the National Capital Region, for just a few hours on the 7th and 8th. Green crackers were designed by the National Environmental Engineering Research Institute in Nagpur, and they contain no barium nitrate.

Prelims trap: the Nagpur institute designs the formula, but the Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation, under the Commerce Ministry, licenses the makers.

3 · Two-child rule

Story three is very close to home for us in the Telugu states.

This week the Supreme Court said laws that stop people with more than two children from contesting panchayat elections have lost relevance, and sent its 2003 Javed judgment to a larger bench. The reason is data: India's fertility rate has fallen to 1.9, below the replacement level of 2.1.

Telugu states lens: Andhra Pradesh scrapped this rule in 2024, and Telangana did the same for rural bodies in 2026. But remember the trap: the Supreme Court has not struck the rule down; it only referred the question.

4 · Fast-track special courts

Story four is about speedy justice for women and children.

The Cabinet extended the fast-track special courts scheme till March 2031, raising the number of courts from 779 to 850. These courts hear rape cases and cases under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, and the Centre’s share comes from the Nirbhaya Fund. Remember, this scheme first began in 2019.

Bridge (on camera)

Four stories done, seven to go.

మీరు ఇక్కడ వరకు ఉంటే, మీరు serious aspirant!

Now let us move from the courts to our rural jobs and our power grid.

5 · Rural jobs law

Story five touches every village.

Under the new rural jobs law, which replaced the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act from July 1, the Rural Development Ministry notified grievance rules: every complaint must be enquired into within 7 working days and solved within 15, at Gram Panchayat, Block and District level. The guarantee itself is now 125 days of work.

Prelims trap: the Centre no longer pays all the wages; the cost is now shared 60 to 40 with the states, and 90 to 10 for Himalayan and north-eastern states.

6 · Storing electricity

Story six answers a simple question: what happens to solar power after sunset?

The Cabinet approved ₹14,500 crore of viability gap funding to build 92 gigawatt-hours of grid-scale storage: 60 from pumped storage, 30 from batteries and 2 from new technologies. Viability gap funding means the government pays part of the cost, so that a project which is useful but not yet profitable becomes viable.

Pumped storage is like a giant water battery: you pump water uphill when power is cheap, and let it fall through turbines when it is needed. Prelims trap: the biggest share here is pumped storage, not batteries.

7 · Pralay missile

Now two defence stories, starting with a missile.

On November 5, the Defence Research and Development Organisation flight-tested Pralay from Doctor A P J Abdul Kalam Island off Odisha. Pralay is a quasi-ballistic missile, which means it can change its path in flight, so it is harder to intercept. Prelims trap: Agni and Prithvi are ballistic missiles, while BrahMos is a cruise missile built with Russia, so do not mix up the families.

8 · Malabar 2026

From land to sea: our eighth story is Exercise Malabar.

Malabar 2026 is being held off Honshu in Japan from the 5th to the 12th of November, with the navies of India, the United States, Japan and Australia; India has sent the frigate Indian Naval Ship Sahyadri.

Prelims trap: Malabar began in 1992 as a two-nation exercise between India and the United States; Japan became a permanent member in 2015, and Australia rejoined in 2020.

Bridge (on camera)

Eight done!

ఇప్పుడు ప్రపంచం వైపు చూద్దాం,

starting with the biggest election story of the week.

9 · America’s midterm elections

Story nine comes from the United States.

In America’s midterm elections, the Democrats won control of the House of Representatives, and reports say they may control the Senate too, though the final count is still pending. Remember the structure: the House has 435 members elected every two years, while the Senate has 100 members with six-year terms, and about a third face election every two years. They are called midterms because they fall halfway through the President’s four-year term.

10 · Day against bullying at school

Now two important days. Story ten was on November 5.

The International Day against Violence and Bullying at School, including Cyberbullying, is held on the first Thursday of November, was first observed in 2020, and one in three students worldwide has been bullied in the past month. Prelims trap: India’s National Commission for Protection of Child Rights is a statutory body under a 2005 Act, not a constitutional one.

11 · National Cancer Awareness Day

And story eleven: November 7 is National Cancer Awareness Day.

It falls on Marie Curie’s birthday, and here is the trap: she won two Nobel Prizes in two different sciences, Physics in 1903 and Chemistry in 1911.

Alert

One alert for Telugu aspirants: Andhra Pradesh has announced its District Selection Committee teacher recruitment for about 2,721 posts, with applications reported from November 11. Please check the official website for exact details.

Quiz

Now, your quick-fire question. How many of these three statements are correct? Pause the video and answer.

(stay silent for 7 seconds)

The answer is only two: statements two and three. Agnipath has been modified, not scrapped. How many did you get right?

Comment చేయండి!

Close (on camera)

That was November’s first week in 10 minutes. If this helped, share it with one friend who is preparing with you, and subscribe for every Sunday’s class.

అందరికీ దీపావళి శుభాకాంక్షలు, green గా జరుపుకుందాం!